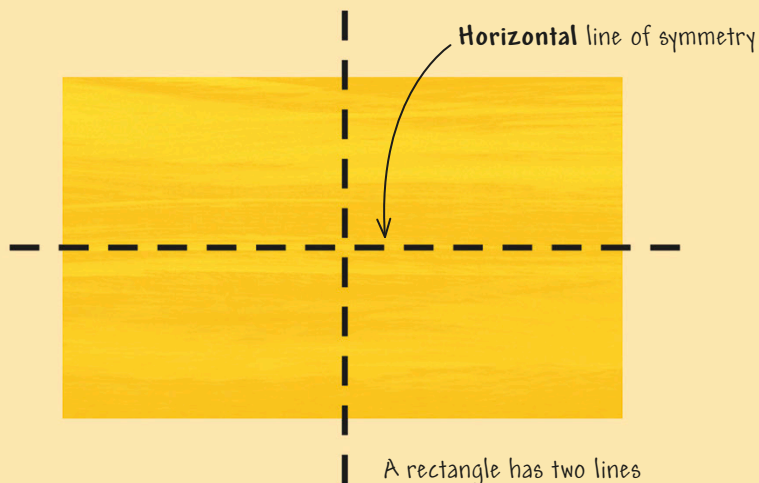


Symmetry

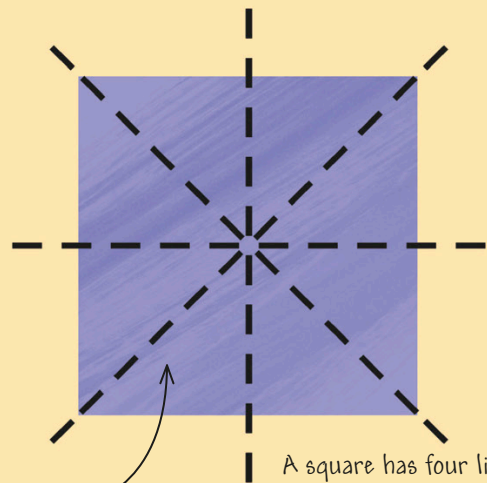
There are two types of symmetry: reflective and rotational. We can see both types of symmetry in the world around us.

Reflective symmetry

A shape has reflective symmetry if you can draw a line through it and split it into two identical halves. Some shapes have no lines of symmetry, while others have many.

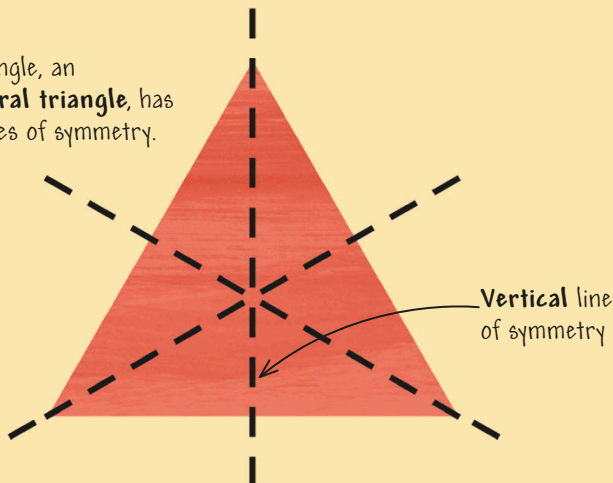


A rectangle has two lines of symmetry, one vertical and the other horizontal.



A square has four lines of symmetry—one vertical, one horizontal, and two diagonal.

This triangle, an **equilateral triangle**, has three lines of symmetry.



This four-sided shape has no lines of symmetry. We say it is **asymmetrical**.



Rotational symmetry

A shape has **rotational symmetry** if it can be turned around at its center until it fits exactly into its original outline. Perfectly formed snowflakes have rotational symmetry.

